

Eye Injuries - Chemical

Key Concepts

- Prolonged irrigation of the eye before and during transport is the key action
- Symptoms can include pain, inability to open the eye, changes in vision or photophobia
- Identify the chemical if possible



EMT/AEMT

- Follow Trauma General Patient Care Guideline
- Remove Contacts
- Irrigate from the nasal side of the affected eye
 - Consider use of Morgan lens
- Normal Saline, Lactated Ringers or water may be used to irrigate the eye
- Irrigation should continue until pain and vision improves or pH of the eye can be measured and pH is 6.5-7.5

Paramedic

- **Tetracaine** 0.5% 2 drops each affected eye every 5 minutes
- Consider use of the Morgan lens apparatus if available.
- Irrigate with **NS, LR or water** while enroute to receiving facility
- Pain control per Pain Management Guideline